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VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

CSE0001 - DIGITAL LITERACY

Project Report

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Introduction

In today's rapidly evolving digital world, digital literacy has become an essential skill for students to succeed both academically and professionally. This project is based on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, whose responsibility is to help peers understand and effectively navigate the digital environment. It emphasizes the importance of responsible online behaviour, professional communication, and building a strong digital presence.

The project consists of five structured tasks, each focusing on a key aspect of digital literacy. These include creating an awareness infographic, developing a professional digital portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, understanding email etiquette, and studying cybercrime with prevention strategies. Each task provides practical experience with widely used tools and platforms. The overall aim of this project is to enhance digital awareness, improve communication skills, and prepare students to use technology safely, responsibly, and effectively in real-world situations.

Task 1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

- **Write-up**

For this task, I created a one-page infographic on digital literacy. The design shows important aspects such as the meaning of digital literacy, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, maintaining a positive online presence, and proper email etiquette. I focused on presenting the information in a simple and visually engaging way so that it is easy for students to understand quickly.

I used Canva to design the infographic because it is easy to use and provides a variety of templates, icons, and design elements. The platform helped me organize the content neatly and make the infographic attractive with the use of colours, headings, and visuals.

While making this infographic, I found it very interesting how design can make information more engaging and impactful. Even basic content can look professional when presented well. However, one difficulty I faced was fitting all the important information into a single page

without making it look crowded. I had to carefully choose what to include and how to arrange it. Overall, this task helped me improve my creativity and understand the importance of digital literacy and effective communication.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

➢ Write-up

For building my professional digital presence, I created and updated profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each of these platforms serves a unique and important purpose in my academic and career journey. GitHub is widely used for showcasing coding projects, collaborating with others, and maintaining a portfolio of technical work. I created a

profile README to highlight my background, branch, and learning goals. LinkedIn is a professional networking platform where I added my education details, including my degree, institution, and expected graduation year, to build a credible academic profile. Kaggle is a platform focused on data science and machine learning, where users can participate in competitions, work with datasets, and improve analytical skills.

Over the next four years, I plan to actively use GitHub to upload my projects, including web development, robotics, and AI-based work. On LinkedIn, I aim to build connections, share achievements, and explore internship opportunities. Through Kaggle, I intend to enhance my data analysis and machine learning skills by participating in competitions and learning from the community. These platforms will help me build a strong digital portfolio and improve my career prospects.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

➢ Write-up

For this task, I used HackerRank for coding practice and Google Workspace tools for collaboration. My HackerRank account was already created in Semester 1, along with other coding platforms such as LeetCode. Continuing my practice, I solved an additional beginner-

level problem on HackerRank, which helped me further strengthen my problem-solving skills and understanding of basic programming concepts like input-output and logical thinking.

For the collaboration part, I used Google Forms to create a “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz” for my batchmates. The form included exactly five questions, with a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer types, focusing on topics like digital tools, safe internet usage, and proper online communication. I also explored the responses through Google Sheets, which automatically collected and organized the data, making it easy to analyze.

These platforms are highly beneficial for academic growth. Coding platforms like HackerRank and LeetCode help improve coding efficiency and logical thinking, which are essential for exams and technical skills. Google Workspace tools support collaboration, data management, and project work effectively. Overall, this task enhanced my digital skills and prepared me for better academic performance.

Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

- **Part B – Create a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist:**

Social Media ***Do’s*** for College Students	Social Media ***Don’ts*** for College Students
Think before you post—ensure your content is respectful and appropriate.	Don’t post offensive, abusive, or inappropriate content.
Maintain a professional tone, especially on platforms like LinkedIn.	Don’t share fake news or unverified information.
Protect your privacy—avoid sharing personal or sensitive information.	Don’t overshare personal details like address, phone number, etc.
Verify information before sharing to prevent spreading misinformation.	Don’t engage in online arguments or trolling.
Be respectful in comments and discussions, even during disagreements.	Don’t ignore your digital footprint—what you post stays online.

- **Situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem:**

A common example of poor digital communication causing problems is when a student posts inappropriate or offensive content on social media without thinking about its consequences.

For instance, a student might share a joke or comment that is misunderstood or considered disrespectful, leading to backlash from peers or even disciplinary action from the college. In some cases, such posts can harm future career opportunities, as employers often review candidates' online presence.

This situation could have been avoided if the student had thought carefully before posting and considered how others might perceive the content. Practicing responsible communication, maintaining professionalism, and respecting others online are essential. Reviewing posts before sharing and understanding the impact of one's digital footprint can prevent such issues.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

- **What surprised me most while researching this topic:**

While researching this topic, what surprised me the most was how common and easily executed cyber frauds, especially UPI scams, have become. I realized that these crimes do not always involve complex hacking techniques but often rely on simple psychological manipulation, such as creating urgency or pretending to be a trusted authority. It was alarming to learn that even well-educated individuals can fall victim to such scams due to a moment of panic or lack of awareness. The speed at which money can be transferred and lost through a single mistaken action was particularly shocking.

- **One habit I will personally change as a result:**

As a result, one habit I will personally change is being more cautious and alert while handling digital transactions. I will make it a point to verify every payment request carefully and avoid clicking on suspicious links. I will also ensure that I never share sensitive information like OTPs or UPI PINs under any circumstances.

Conclusion

Overall, this project provided valuable insights into the importance of digital literacy in today's world. It helped me develop essential skills such as professional communication, responsible social media usage, and awareness of online safety. I gained practical experience in creating a digital portfolio, using coding and collaboration platforms, and

understanding cyber threats like UPI fraud. Each task contributed to improving my confidence in using digital tools effectively. This project has also made me more conscious of my digital footprint and online behaviour. Overall, it has prepared me to navigate the digital world more responsibly and build a strong foundation for my academic and professional future.

References

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